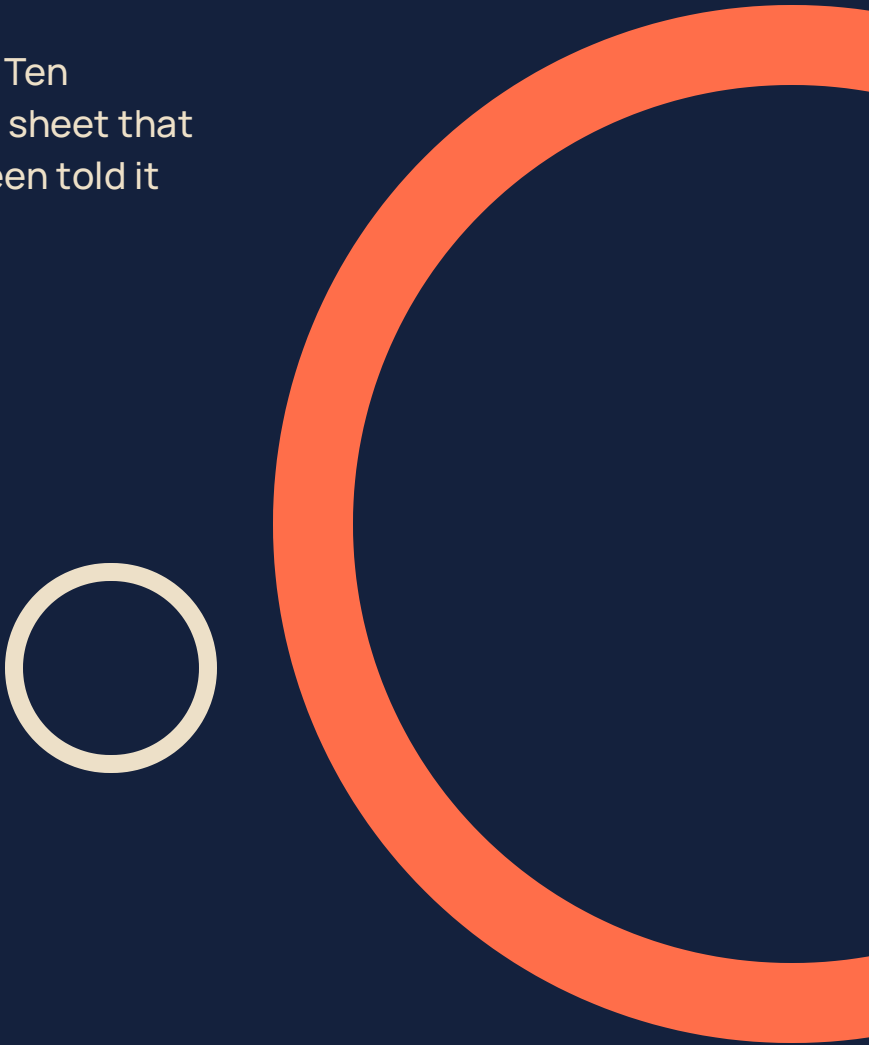


The AI Starter Kit

Stop using AI like a search engine. Ten prompts, one formula, and a cheat sheet that turn it into the assistant you've been told it could be.

- 
- 01 The formula
 - 02 10 copy-paste prompts
 - 03 Which AI to use (and what it costs)
 - 04 What a week with AI actually looks like
 - 05 The one-page cheat sheet

Why your AI answers feel generic

Most people type AI a question the way they'd type Google a search. Short in, generic out. AI isn't a search box — it's closer to a sharp new coworker who knows nothing about you. Brief it like one.

1

Role

Who should it act as?
"Act as a hiring manager in healthcare."

2

Context

What does it need to know? Your situation, audience, constraints.

3

Task

Exactly what you want done — one clear job.

4

Format

What the answer should look like: length, bullets, table, tone.

SEARCH-ENGINE HABIT

~~write a cover letter~~

ROLE · CONTEXT · TASK · FORMAT

Act as a recruiter who has read 10,000 cover letters. I'm applying for a project coordinator role at a hospital; I've spent 6 years in retail management and I'm good at scheduling and calming upset customers. Write a cover letter that connects my retail experience to this role without apologizing for it. Keep it under 250 words, warm but confident, no clichés like "I am writing to express my interest."

Three habits that matter more than the perfect prompt

Keep talking.

The first answer is a draft. Reply "shorter," "more specific," "sound more like me." The magic is in the second and third message.

Give it your stuff.

Paste the job posting, the email thread, your notes. Real material beats description every time.

Let it ask you.

End any prompt with "Ask me questions before you start." It'll pull out the context you forgot to give.

Check the facts.

AI can sound certain and still be wrong. Anything that matters — numbers, names, dates, laws — verify it.

10 prompts worth stealing

Copy them, swap the **[coral brackets]** for your details, and paste into any AI tool. They work in ChatGPT, Claude, Gemini, or Copilot.

01 The "Interview Me First"

ANY TASK

The single biggest upgrade. Instead of guessing, the AI pulls the context out of you.

COPY

I want help with **[the task — e.g. planning my kid's birthday / writing a LinkedIn post / fixing my budget]**. Before you give me anything, ask me up to 5 questions, one at a time, that you need answered to do this really well. After my last answer, give me your best version.

02 Explain It Like I'm New

LEARNING

Learn anything — a new job skill, a medical bill, a lease — without feeling dumb.

COPY

Explain **[topic]** to me like I'm smart but completely new to it. Use one everyday analogy, then give me the 3 things that actually matter and the 1 mistake beginners make. Finish with a 3-question quiz so I know I've got it.

03 The Resume Bullet Upgrade

JOB SEARCH

Turns "responsible for" duties into results a hiring manager actually notices.

COPY

Act as a hiring manager for **[target job title]**. Here are bullets from my resume: **[paste bullets]**. Rewrite each one to lead with a strong verb and show a result. Where a number would help and I haven't given one, ask me for it — don't invent it. Show before and after side by side.

Why "don't invent it" matters: AI will happily make up impressive numbers. Recruiters ask about them in interviews.

04 The Job Posting Decoder

JOB SEARCH

See what a posting is really asking for — and exactly where you match.

COPY

Here's a job posting: **[paste posting]**. And here's my resume: **[paste resume]**. Give me: (1) the 5 things this employer cares about most, in plain English, (2) where I'm a strong match, with proof from my resume, (3) my honest gaps and how I could address each one in my application.

05 The Practice Interviewer

JOB SEARCH

Rehearse out loud with a patient interviewer who gives real feedback.

COPY

Act as an interviewer for a **[job title]** role at a **[type of company]**. Ask me one interview question at a time — mix of behavioral and role-specific. After each answer, tell me what worked, what was weak, and show me a stronger version using my own details. Don't move to the next question until I say "next."

Try it with **voice mode** on your phone. Answering out loud is closer to the real thing.

06 The Hard Email

EVERYDAY WORK

For the message you've been putting off: asking for a raise, pushing back, saying no.

COPY

Help me write an email to **[who — e.g. my manager / a landlord / a client]**. Situation: **[what happened]**. What I want: **[the outcome]**. Give me 2 versions — one direct, one softer — each under 150 words. Sound like a calm, confident person, not a corporate robot.

07 Mess to Action List

EVERYDAY WORK

Meeting notes, voice memos, a chaotic group chat — turned into who does what by when.

COPY

Below are my messy notes from **[a meeting / a phone call / my brain dump]**. Turn them into: (1) a 3-sentence summary, (2) a list of action items with who owns each and any deadline mentioned, (3) open questions nobody answered. If something's unclear, flag it instead of guessing. Notes: **[paste]**

08 Plan My Week (For Real)

LIFE

A schedule built around your actual energy and obligations, not an ideal robot's.

COPY

Help me plan next week. Fixed commitments: **[work hours, kids' pickups, appointments]**. Things I need to get done: **[list]**. I have the most energy **[mornings / evenings]**. Build a realistic day-by-day plan with buffer time, put the hardest task where my energy is highest, and tell me what to drop if the week goes sideways.

09 The Decision Helper

LIFE

Stuck between options? Get the angles you haven't considered — without it deciding for you.

COPY

I'm deciding between **[option A]** and **[option B]**. What matters most to me: **[e.g. money, time with family, stability]**. Lay out the pros, cons, and hidden costs of each, then tell me what would have to be true for each option to be the right call. Ask me anything you need to know. Don't pick for me — help me see it clearly.

10 The Honest Critic

ANY TASK

AI is polite by default. This makes it tell you what's actually wrong — then fix it.

COPY

Here's something I wrote: **[paste — resume, post, email, essay]**. Its goal is **[what it needs to do]**. Be a tough but fair editor: list the 3 biggest problems in order of importance, explain why each one hurts, then give me a revised version that fixes them. Don't soften the feedback.

STACK THEM

The real power move is chaining: **#04** to decode a job posting → **#03** to rewrite your bullets for it → **#10** to critique the result → **#05** to practice the interview. That's an afternoon of work that used to take a week.

YOUR FIRST 10 MINUTES

Don't read all ten. Do one.

1. Open whichever AI you already have — free is fine.
2. Paste **Prompt #01** and fill in something real from your week.
3. Answer its questions honestly. Short answers are fine.
4. When the result comes back, reply once with a fix-it line from the cheat sheet.
5. Compare that to what you'd have gotten from a one-line question. That gap is the whole kit.

Which AI should you use?

Short answer: start free, pick the one you'll actually open every day, and pay only when you keep hitting the limits. All four are good. They're just good at different things.

	ChatGPT	Claude	Gemini	Copilot
MADE BY	OpenAI	Anthropic	Google	Microsoft
BEST AT	All-rounder; images; voice conversations	Writing that sounds human; long documents; careful reasoning	Anything inside Gmail, Docs & Google search	Word, Excel, Outlook & Teams users
FREE PLAN	Unlimited everyday text chat; images, uploads & advanced tools capped	Solid free tier with a message cap that resets every few hours	Free tier with usage limits that reset every few hours	Free Copilot chat
CHEAPEST UPGRADE	Go · \$8/mo	Pro · \$20/mo (\$17/mo billed yearly)	AI Plus · \$4.99/mo	M365 plans with Copilot built in
MAIN PAID PLAN	Plus · \$20/mo	Pro · \$20/mo	AI Pro · \$19.99/mo	Varies by Microsoft 365 plan
WATCH OUT FOR	Ads on free & Go tiers in the US	Free cap hits fast on heavy days	Best features tied to Google account	Most useful only if you live in Office

Job hunting?

Claude or ChatGPT for resumes and cover letters. Try the same prompt in both — keep whichever sounds more like you.

Live in Gmail?

Gemini. It's already where your email and docs are. US college students may qualify for AI Pro free.

Office job on Microsoft?

Copilot is probably already in your work tools. Check before you pay for anything.

Just starting?

ChatGPT's free plan. Unlimited everyday chats means you can practice without watching a counter.

Prices and limits as of September 2026. AI companies change plans often — check the official pricing page before you pay. Never paste passwords, account numbers, or your SSN into any AI tool, and check your settings for whether chats are used to train the model.

One ordinary week, about five hours back

Meet Dana — an example, not a real person, but built from the tasks people tell us eat their week. She manages a small office, is quietly job hunting, and has two kids. Nothing fancy. Just the prompts in this kit.

Monday — the inbox.

A vendor messed up an order and she's been avoiding the reply. Prompt #06 gives her a firm, polite email in two minutes instead of twenty minutes of drafting and deleting.

Tuesday — the meeting.

She pastes her scribbled notes into Prompt #07. Action items with owners go out before she's left her desk. No more "wait, who was doing that?"

Wednesday — the job she wants.

A posting she likes goes up. Prompt #04 shows her she matches 4 of 5 priorities; Prompt #03 rewrites her bullets to prove it. Application done in one lunch break.

Thursday — the interview.

She gets a call-back. Twenty minutes of Prompt #05 in the car (voice mode, parked) and she walks in having already answered the hard questions once.

Sunday — the week ahead.

Prompt #08 turns soccer practice, a dentist appointment and two deadlines into a plan she can actually follow.

Time saved (estimates)

Hard emails, all week	~1 hr
Meeting follow-ups	~45 min
Tailoring one application	~1.5 hrs
Interview prep	~1 hr
Weekly planning	~30 min

Total ~4.75 hrs

That's not a productivity hack. That's an evening with her kids — every week.

Your number will be different. The point isn't the exact figure — it's that the savings come from ordinary tasks, not from becoming a "tech person."

Print this. Tape it by your screen.

The formula

Role – “Act as a...” · **Context** – who, what, why, constraints · **Task** – one clear job · **Format** – length, layout, tone

Power phrases

“Ask me questions first.” Pulls out missing context

“Give me 3 options.” Stops you settling for the first draft

“Show before and after.” See exactly what changed

“Explain your reasoning.” Catch bad logic early

“Don’t invent facts – ask me.” Stops made-up numbers

“Sound like a real person.” Kills corporate-speak

Fix-it replies

Too long? “Cut this in half. Keep the best parts.”

Too generic? “Make it specific to my situation.”

Too stiff? “Rewrite like I’m talking to a friend.”

Too nice? “Be blunt. What’s actually wrong?”

Went off track? “Start over. Here’s what I really need...”

Almost right? “Keep everything, just change ____.”

Never paste in

Passwords or login codes

Social Security, bank or card numbers

Your company’s confidential info (check your employer’s AI policy)

Other people’s private details

Always double-check

Numbers, dates and statistics

Names, titles, quotes

Anything legal, medical or financial

Links and sources – ask for them, then open them

The one rule

Treat the first answer as a **draft**, not a verdict. The difference between people who say “AI is overrated” and people who say “AI saves me hours” is usually one follow-up message.

WHAT'S NEXT

You've got the basics. Here's where it goes.

Everything in this kit is free and stays free — no gatekeeping. If you're job hunting and want the full system, that's what we built next.

Free

YOU ARE HERE

AI Starter Kit

The formula, 10 prompts, the tool guide and the cheat sheet. Plus a short email series over the next 10 days with one new technique each time.

\$27

30-DAY
PLAYBOOK

How to Get Hired Using AI (Without Getting Rejected)

A day-by-day, 30-day plan: resume, LinkedIn, applications, networking messages and interview prep — with the prompts for every step, and how to use AI without your application reading like AI wrote it.

\$147

COACH +
BLUEPRINT

Gateway Interview Coach + Blueprint

A personalized AI interview coach set up for your target role — plus the step-by-step Blueprint showing how to build it yourself, so you own the skill, not just the tool.

\$174

BUNDLE

Playbook + Coach together

Both, for when you want the plan and the practice partner.



Follow @argateway on TikTok

A new prompt, tutorial or tool comparison every day. See something useful? Send it to one person who's still using AI like a search engine.